

IE8 might be the last version of the Internet Explorer web browser

Steve Jobs stated at Macworld 2008 that over 20% of Macs use Leopard as their operating system

TOOLBOX

can check "Include updated website lists from Microsoft" which will get an updated compatibility list from Microsoft itself. For those who don't want any changes to be viewed at all, you can opt to view all the web sites in Compatibility View by putting a check next to "Display all websites in Compatibility View".

Accelerators

Everyday browsing tasks like translating a word or a line, mapping an address and other such tasks are normally done by opening a new web site for each one separately. IE8 has an interesting new feature to perform all these tasks on the spot,

Translate words quickly with Accelerators

Free encyclopedia

is a device that uses electric fields to propel

s and contain ...

- 88k - Cached - Similar pages

Blog with Windows Live

E-mail with Windows Live

Map with Live Search

Search with Google

Translate with Live Search

All Accelerators

English - German

Change Language

Partikel-Beschleuniger (oder

atom-smasher [1]) ist

Translation powered by Microsoft Translator

First, since all particles behave like

particle's momentum, ...

- 5k - Cached - Similar pages

ipx

edia, the free encyclopedia

series of movies by Mattel. It is

e Entertainment out of Vancouver, ...

lacers

making browsing more efficient. When you highlight some text on the web site you are currently viewing a small icon appears — the Accelerators icon. Either click that icon or simply right-click to get a list of options that you can perform for your selection. By default, you can add that text to your Windows Live Blog, email with Windows Live, Map with Live Search, Search with Google and even Translate with Live Search, and other such daily tasks. Some of them don't even need you to visit another web site. For example, a definition of the highlighted word will be displayed in a small box when you just mouse over one of the accelerator options. You can download and add more accelerators from www.ieaddons.com.

Caret browsing

An alternative to using a mouse to select text and navigate around within a web page, you can use the navigation keys on the keyboard — Home, End, Page Up, Page Down and the arrow keys. This feature in IE8 is called caret browsing. To use this feature, you just need to hit the [F7] key. On activating caret browsing, click once on any text on the web site you are currently viewing. You will see a cursor that you can now navigate with freely.

MAC OS X LEOPARD

The Basics

Here's how you can optimise the way you work with OS X.

Use Exposé smartly

If you've got many windows open, Exposé seems to lose its productivity somewhat — if you can't identify the content of a window (usually the case with documents), you'll have to hover your mouse cursor over it to see its filename. Instead, use Exposé's Application Windows function — hit [F10].

Use Exposé's Application Windows more often



Now use [Cmd] + [Tab] to switch between programs, and you'll see each application's windows laid out as you switch to it.

Get special

characters easily

If you're a former Windows user, you're used to using [Alt] codes or the Character Map for special characters and diacritic marks (such as umlauts - ü - for example). On the Mac, you can get your special characters by holding down [Option] or [Option] + [Shift] and pressing any of the keys on your keyboard. For example, press [Option] + [Shift] + [8] to get the degrees (°) symbol, and just [Option] + [8] for a bullet (•).

For characters that you can't find this way, there's always the Character Palette. Go to System Preferences > International > Input Menu. Turn on the Character Palette at the top, and check the box against Show input menu in menu bar at the bottom. You'll now be able to open the Character Palette

Tame the volume control



by clicking on the US flag (for US keyboard layout) in your menu bar.

Control volume control

Having dedicated keys for volume control is nice, but you might wish for finer control over it — why must you be restricted to those squares? To adjust your volume in smaller increments, hold down [Option] and [Shift] as you use the volume control buttons.

Stop using the Dock

The Dock is a great feature during the first week or so with your Mac, but in the long run, it's mostly useless. With Spotlight, [Cmd] + [Tab] and Exposé, the only reasons you should need the dock are for Stacks, and for the Trash.

The first thing you should do to the dock is to remove all the shortcuts (click and drag the icons out of the dock, and they'll vanish in a puff). To launch applications, use [Cmd] + [Space] to start Spotlight, and type in the first few letters of the application's name. This way, the Dock will only contain applications that are running, and be clear otherwise.

Once that's done, hide the dock so that it doesn't take up valuable real estate. Right-click (or [Control] + click) on the grey divider between the applications and stacks, and choose Turn Hiding On. You can use [Cmd] + [Tab] to switch between applications, and in time, you won't miss the dock at all.

Use the active corners

If you don't want to tie too many of your function keys with Exposé or related shortcuts, you set these features (and several others) to activate when you move the mouse to the corners of your screen.

You'll find these settings under System Preferences > Exposé & Spaces > Exposé. If you own a MacBook or MacBook Pro, you could set one of the corners to turn off the screen — a great power saver when you're running on batteries.

Kill Caps Lock

If we had our way, the Caps Lock key wouldn't feature on any keyboard — it serves